

Denise Barrett

Product designer and leader · Open to Staff & Principal roles

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Remote (US)

I design for durability. Ten years designing B2B SaaS platforms — the layer other teams build on — serving 100K+ small businesses. Most fragmentation is a surface problem, not a foundation problem, so I unify the surface and protect what's underneath. I measure before I design, and treat AI as a material I design with rather than a tool I reach for.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Designer · Keap, acquired by Thryv 2022 – Present

Platform design across forms, branding, listings and AI for a sales-and-marketing platform for small businesses. Lead design for two development teams.

- **Unified seven form builders into one system** as the sole designer on the initiative — framed the problem, ran the research, designed the builder end to end and sold the roadmap. Argued down the assumed full rebuild by showing the data models were sound and the fragmentation surface-level — avoiding 12+ months and its regression risk.
- **Changed the roadmap with research.** Ran a 25-person survey with two researchers, a nine-platform competitor audit and a Kano study; took the results to leadership and reordered the plan — conditional logic moved up, payments came out. Shipped all three top-ranked parity features (Jan–Aug 2026).
- **Designed one brand definition across four product surfaces and 16 dependent teams.** Owned research (13 discovery interviews, five-platform audit, a concept test chosen 4 of 4) and IA; wrote the three rules — reference never copy, one primary, degrade to a placeholder — that let it scale. Three releases shipped.
- **Won the slower architecture on a design argument.** Backed engineering's keys-not-IDs proposal over raw IDs by showing sharing scope would have to widen later; that decision is why the system still holds.
- **Lead design and research on a platform-wide listings vendor migration** (160K locations; 2 leads, 4 PMs, 2 designers). Specified a vendor-agnostic abstraction layer so the frontend survives either vendor; consolidated three A-grade usability studies into the bar any vendor must clear; argued an AI approve/decline interaction model into the procurement scorecard.
- **Win alignment with working prototypes** wired to live APIs — an AI-assisted prototype landed leadership sign-off on a three-year vision after slides had failed to.
- **Facilitate and mentor.** Run cross-team workshops with PMs, tech leads and engineers, and a cross-product AI ideation session across five product areas; mentor a junior designer on execution and design-system decisions; lead UX team meetings and support the Design Manager on process and strategy.

Senior UX/UI Designer · Blue Raster 2020 – 2022

Digital agency: data visualisation and geospatial solutions for government and enterprise clients.

- Led UX/UI from research through implementation across multiple client projects, improving user adoption.
- Translated complex needs from government agencies and enterprise clients into intuitive solutions, and streamlined design workflows with developers.

Product Designer · Allego 2017 – 2020

- Designed sales-enablement tools for an enterprise learning platform, alongside senior designers and engineers — where I built my enterprise UX and research practice.

SELECTED WORK

Seven builders, one system 2024–26

One definition, every surface 2023–26

One UX, two possible backends 2026

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SKILLS

- Platform & design systems
- Systems thinking
- Information architecture
- UX research Usability testing
- Kano & prioritisation
- AI product design
- Vendor-agnostic architecture
- Cross-functional influence
- Workshop facilitation
- Mentorship Accessibility

Tools

Figma · AI-assisted prototyping (Claude Code) · Confluence · Jira · Miro

EDUCATION

UX Management

Nielsen Norman Group

MFA, Visual Communication Design

Rochester Institute of Technology · 2014–2016

BA, Graphic Design

University of Shanghai for Science and Technology

AWARDS

Esri Ocean Storymap Contest
First Place · 2021

CGDA Visual Communication Design
Excellence Award · 2016